

## ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Factor investing is all about coping with—and exploiting—bad times. I’ve had the opposite experience writing this book—I’ve genuinely enjoyed some good times. That’s because I’ve been fortunate to have many people in my life who have made this project a pleasure.

For their able research assistance, I thank Andrés Ayala, Bingxu Chen, Katrina Evtimova, Sergiy Gorovyy, Rudy Loo-Kung, Christy Wong, and Yu Zhang.

My work for Norway, especially my consulting for Norges Bank and the Ministry of Finance, has hugely influenced my thinking, and I am truly honored to have worked with many excellent people there. In particular I thank Sigbjørn Alte Berg, Pål Haugerud, Knut Kjær, Martin Skancke, Yngve Slyngstad, and all the members of Norges Bank, Norges Bank Investment Management, and the Ministry of Finance with whom I have worked. I also thank my fellow advisers to Norway: Antti Ilmanen, Gerlof de Vrij, and Sung Cheng Chih. I feel that I learned more from all of you than what I contributed in our meetings. I especially thank Antti, himself the author of a superb book called *Expected Returns: An Investor’s Guide to Harvesting Market Rewards*, who generously provided detailed comments on the first draft of every chapter.

Most of my research focuses on asset management issues, and in my life as a scholar I’ve been blessed with co-authors who have taught me a great deal. It has been exciting working together—thank you. I acknowledge those whose joint research appears in this book: Geert Bekaert, Vineer Bhansali, Jean Boivin, Nick Bollen, Marie Brière, Bingxu Chen, Joe Chen, Sen Dong, Will Goetzmann, Sergiy Gorovyy, Rick Green, Bob Hodrick, Greg van Inwegen, Jun Liu, Francis Longstaff, Rudy Loo-Kung, Knut Kjær, Dennis Kristensen, Angela Maddaloni, Neil Nabar, Dimitris Papanikolaou, Monika Piazzesi, Matt Rhodes-Kropf, Stephen Schaefer, Assaf Shtauber, Ombretta Signore, Morten Sorensen, Suresh Sundaresan, Paul Tetlock, Allan Timmermann, Maxim Ulrich, Sam Wald, Min Wei, Mark Westerfield, Yuhang Xing, Xiaoyan Zhang, and Rui Zhao. Thank you to many of you for feedback, and also thank you to my co-author Ludovic Phalippou, although our research wasn’t finished in time for the book.